

Alana Edwards

UX-Focused Software Engineer | Product & Interaction Design | Chicago, IL, 60605,
USA | 3127143918 | alanaedwardscareers@gmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/alana-edwards00>

SUMMARY

Product-driven Software Engineer with hands-on experience designing and building user-centered web and mobile applications. Strong background translating user needs and product requirements into intuitive interfaces using Figma, SwiftUI, React, and Rails. Experienced in agile, cross-functional environments, combining UX thinking, frontend development, and backend APIs to deliver scalable, accessible, and impactful products. Currently enhancing product design and AI-driven UX skills through a selective UX apprenticeship.

SKILLS

UX / PRODUCT: UX Design Principles, Wireframing & Prototyping (Figma), User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, MVP & Product Thinking, Usability-Focused Design, Design-to-Engineering Collaboration

FRONTEND: HTML, CSS, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, AJAX/jQuery, SwiftUI, MapKit, Responsive & Accessible UI

BACKEND & APIs: Ruby on Rails, Sinatra, Python, Flask, FastAPI, REST APIs, OAuth (GitHub, Google, Mapbox), PostgreSQL, MySQL

ENGINEERING & DELIVERY: Git/GitHub, Agile/Scrum (Jira), Test-Driven Development (RSpec, Minitest, unittest), CI/CD (GitHub Actions)

WORK EXPERIENCE

UX Woman

UX Apprentice (Incoming), Remote

Spring 2026

- Selected as 1 of 2 participants for the highly competitive UX Woman Spring 2026 UX Apprenticeship
- Leading an end-to-end UX project for a startup concept, from discovery research through wireframing, prototyping, and iteration
- Conducting user discovery research and synthesizing insights to inform product and design decisions
- Creating core UX deliverables including personas, journey maps, UX flows, wireframes, and prototypes
- Developing business and product context through market analysis, positioning, and UX-driven product pitches

Meta x MLH Fellowship

Production Engineer (Site Reliability Engineer) Fellow, Remote

June 2025 - September 2025

- Selected for the highly competitive Meta x MLH Fellowship, with an acceptance rate of just 2.5%, to contribute to impactful real-world infrastructure projects
- Engineered and deployed a scalable, containerized application using Docker and Nginx on DigitalOcean
- Automated CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions to improve deployment speed and reliability
- Administered Linux servers, writing Bash scripts, and monitoring system performance to ensure uptime
- Implemented unit tests to validate key application functionality
- Partnered with Meta engineers to implement production-grade infrastructure and best practices

Everyone Can Code Chicago

iOS App Developer Intern, Chicago, IL

June 2024 - August 2024

- Collaborated with a team of developers to design and implement iOS app features
- Created wireframes and storyboards in Figma to explore early product concepts
- Built interactive user interfaces using SwiftUI and MapKit
- Delivered a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) pitch to Apple executives
- Used Git for version control in a team-based development environment

Discovery Partners Institute

Software Developer Apprentice, Chicago, IL

February 2024 - May 2024

- Conducted user research, gathered feedback, and created user stories to define requirements before coding
- Designed wireframes and UX flows to guide development of responsive, user-friendly interfaces
- Developed scalable full-stack applications using Ruby on Rails and PostgreSQL, applying object-oriented programming principles and a problem-first approach
- Implemented front-end features with HTML, CSS, and jQuery, ensuring responsive and user-friendly interfaces
- Utilized AWS for image storage, enhancing application functionality and performance

PROJECTS

Build Carolina Academy
SecureAKey

Remote
July 2025 - Present

- Developed an API key scanning tool that identifies exposed API keys in GitHub repositories
- Enabled users to log in via GitHub OAuth, input a repository name, and receive a detailed report showing the exact key, file name, and line number of exposed secrets
- Tech stack: FastAPI (backend, GitHub API integration), React (frontend), PostgreSQL/Supabase (database), GitHub OAuth + JWT (auth), deployed via Render

Discovery Partners Institute
Muse

Chicago, IL
March 2024 - Present

- Pioneered an innovative customer-driven web app; employing a unique sales approach to differentiate itself from competitors, leading to a substantial increase in customer retention
- Improves user experience by making shopping easier and more convenient for customers while increasing seller, merchant, and retail sales
- Curated social media inspired UI for improved listing discoverability
- Incorporated user feedback on application development to gain a better understanding of customers' shopping experience

Personal Project
Restaurant Reservation System

Chicago, IL
September 2024 - September 2024

- Conceptualized a restaurant reservation app with a clean and intuitive UI; enabling users to efficiently make new reservations based on table availability and boosting restaurant sales
- Implemented Test Driven Development using RSpec; ensuring code coverage and reliability

Discovery Partners Institute
Homeless Resource Index

Chicago, IL
January 2024 - January 2024

- Developed a lightweight resource-indexing application using Ruby and Sinatra
- Implemented Google Places API to locate resources in real time; improving search results' speed and accuracy
- Provides those experiencing homelessness and housing insecurity with a directory of resources based on geographic location

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Build Carolina Academy
Teaching Assistant, Remote

April 2025 - August 2025

- Assisted 7 students in a 20-week part-time coding bootcamp with assignments and technical challenges, providing one-on-one and small group support
- Addressed student questions, escalating unresolved issues to the instructor or relevant staff
- Fostered collaboration by connecting students with similar challenges and guiding peer-to-peer problem solving
- Collaborated with the instructor to develop and review content, ensuring all materials are approved prior to distribution
- Gained hands-on experience with foundational Python, React, FastAPI, and Supabase/PostgreSQL

EDUCATION

Illinois Institute of Technology Stuart School of Business, Chicago, IL
Graduate level coursework

University of Illinois - Discovery Partners Institute Tech Apprenticeship, Chicago, IL
Certificate of Completion Software Development

- Relevant coursework: Software Engineering

LANGUAGE

Korean: (Limited working proficiency), **Swedish** (Elementary proficiency)

HONORS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Northwestern University Enrichment Program Certificate
Northwestern University

- Received a certificate for successful completion of a Lego robotics course and Scratch I & II programming courses

Most Improved Dancer of the Year
Ballet

- Awarded title of "Most Improved Dancer of the Year" in recognition of significant progress and excellence in performance

INTERESTS

Crochet, Reading, Video Gaming, Tennis, Photography, Music, Soccer, Dance, Traveling